

value of more than ₹90,000 crore after knocking off their debt of ₹50 crore.

The Adani Group did not respond to a detailed questionnaire from *Business Today* for this story.

MUCH AS THE robustness of the businesses is acknowledged, but the ability to raise money with ease, as it was earlier, is bound to be hit as lenders turn jittery after the Hindenburg charges. Despite the brave faces, even Indian lenders will need to think hard before cutting big cheques for the group in the near future.

As part of his media interactions in January—ahead of the ill-fated FPO—Jugeshinder Singh, Group CFO of the conglomerate, had said that \$50 billion was the planned capex for the green hydrogen business alone. Lenders point to the inherent difficulties of this exercise in the domestic and international markets given the current situation. On the face of it, the stakes outside Indian shores are more complicated. After the Credit Suisse and Citi actions, S&P Dow Jones has removed Adani Enterprises from its sustainability indices while Morgan Stanley Capital International has lowered the free float factor of Adani Enterprises, Adani Transmission, Adani Total Gas and ACC.

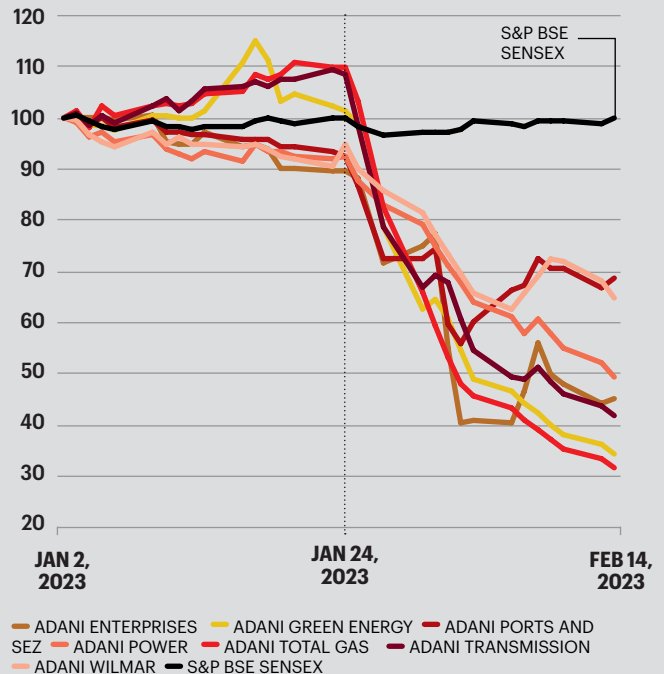
Bankers say that in the international market, some investors will hold on to the group's bonds but the worry is that "investors generally panic". Besides, they explain, there are "vulture investors" who will come in to push the price down and lead to higher bond yields. "At the crux is to restore confidence to ensure the repricing of bonds takes place. Besides, the vulture funds will be hugely attracted to the yields, which they don't see in any other part of the world," says a corporate banker.

Speaking of confidence-building measures—a term used more in diplomacy and military warfare—the group is leaving no stone unturned. On February 6, the group said that the promoters have prepaid \$1.1 billion to release share pledges in three group companies—Adani Ports & SEZ, Adani Green and Adani Transmission—although it was accompanied by the usual speculation around margin calls being triggered that typically happen post a sharp and swift fall in share prices. The money for this came from the group's unlisted entities, which are said to have reserve capital of close to \$3 billion to meet any contingency.

Then, the development related to timely coupon

SHORT AND SQUEEZED

Adani Group stocks have been pounded in recent times at the bourses

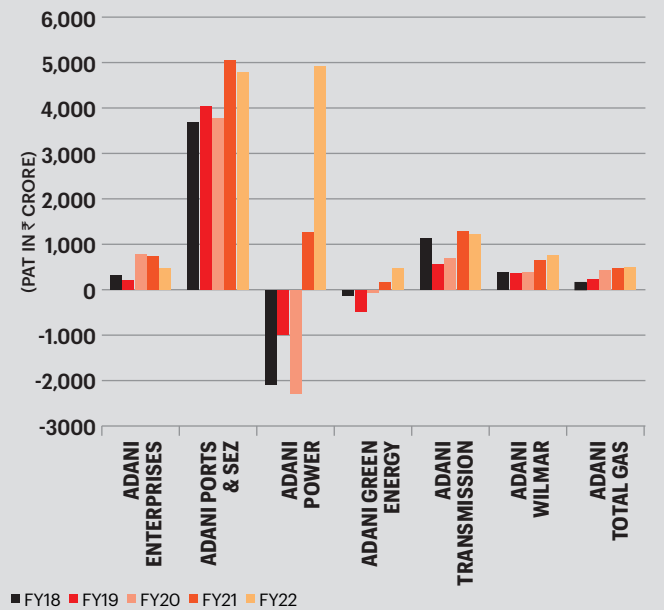


BASE=100

SOURCE ACE EQUITY

BOTTOM LINE

Profit across all Adani Group firms



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